

Filterstation 2 Manual

Audio Damage, Inc.

Release 2.3



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System Requirements

The following table summarizes the operating system requirements and formats provided for Filterstation. Filterstation is a 64-bit plugin.

Operating System	Minimum Version	Formats
macOS	10.13	AAX, AudioUnit, CLAP, VST3; Intel and Apple Silicon
Windows	10.0 version 1607	AAX, CLAP, VST3
Ubuntu	18.0	CLAP, LV2, VST3
iOS (separate purchase)	iOS 12	AUv3

Demonstration Version

We encourage you to download and try the demonstration version of Filterstation before purchasing it. The demo version of Filterstation is the same as the regular version, but has the following limitations:

- Presets cannot be saved, nor can parameter values or other settings. This includes the information usually stored by your host DAW. If you save a DAW session with an instance of the demo version of Filterstation, the plugin will revert to its default state when you reload the session.
- Filterstation will cease to emit audio altogether 20 minutes after you add it to your DAW session. You can remove it and add it again, but it will revert to its default state.

If you purchase Filterstation after using the demonstration version, simply run the installer provided to you after your purchase to replace the demo version with the full version.

Introduction

Filterstation exists because of a simple premise: everyone needs some good filters. While filters have always been central features of analog synthesizers, they're now used on just about everything in modern music production: vocals, drums, guitar, cello, whatever. Anything that makes noise can make more interesting noise if you add a filter. A static filter can gently or radically shape the tone of an instrument, while a filter modulated by an LFO can create anything from subtle animation to wild, screeching sweeps.

Filterstation satisfies this need by providing two filters in one plug-in, each able to operate in twelve different modes. A simple but flexible low-frequency oscillator, with optional tempo sync, and an envelope follower set Filterstation's filters in motion. Filterstation's clean, direct user interface won't get in the way of applying exciting filter effects to your music.

New in Version 2.3

Version 2.3 brings Filterstation up to date with current plugin formats, operating systems, and supporting frameworks. In addition there are some improvements and fixes:

- Brand-new preset browser, now with favorites.
- Added a smooth, click-free master Bypass.
- New visuals selector: waveform, spectrum analyzer, or off.
- Filter LFO and Envelope amount sliders are now properly bipolar.
- Envelope Attack and Decay sliders now give finer control at the low end.
- Doubled the available LFO and envelope modulation depth (existing presets are preserved).
- The window remembers its size.
- Refreshed About box with web, Discord, and support links.
- Now also available in CLAP and LV2.

New in Version 2.0

Version 2.0 improves Filterstation in many ways:

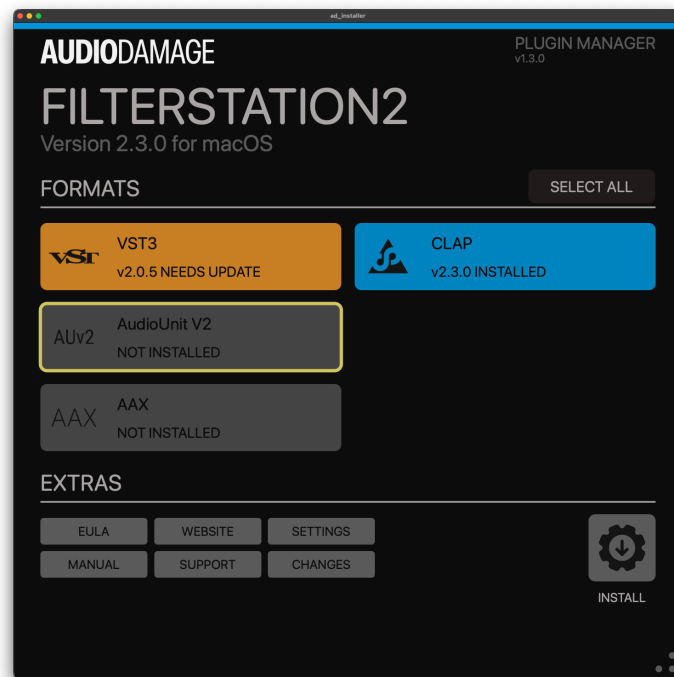
- A completely new user interface. No more fiddly digit-based controls.
- New sound-mangling controls: Feedback, FM, and Hack
- The envelope follower and side-chain input now operate in stereo.
- The user interface is resizable and appropriate to contemporary display technologies.
- Filterstation is now compatible with AAX hosts.
- Presets use a cross-platform XML-based file format.
- Filterstation is built with up-to-date code libraries for better host compatibility and future-proofing.

Filterstation version 2 has a different name and internal identifier than version 1. This means that you can install version 2 alongside whatever version you are currently using, and continue to use the older version in your existing projects. Version 2 cannot be directly substituted in existing projects and cannot read preset files created by version 1.

Also, direct MIDI control assignment has been removed. Host DAWs have progressed considerably since Filterstation's last major revision and it's now appropriate to leave MIDI mapping up to them.

Installation

Filterstation uses our custom plugin manager application for installation. Launch it as usual on your operating system of choice and you'll be presented with a window like this:



Near the top of the window, beneath the name of the plugin, you'll see the version number of the software carried by the installer. This is distinct from the version of the plugin manager itself, which is shown in the upper right and usually not of much interest. (Note that the version numbers in this screenshot are for demonstration purposes only and may not reflect the actual version numbers of the software at the time you read this manual.)

Under the heading FORMATS are large buttons corresponding to the plugin formats which can be installed: AAX, AU, CLAP, LV2 and/or VST3, depending on the operating system. If the plugin is already present on your system in one or more formats (i.e. if you're upgrading from a previous version), the corresponding button is drawn in blue. When possible, the version number of the existing plugin is also shown. If the installer contains a newer version of the plugin than the one(s) already installed, the button is drawn in orange to alert you to the fact that an update is available. If a format is not present on your system, its button is drawn in gray.

Click a button to select the format for installation. A yellow outline appears around the button to indicate that its format will be installed. In the above screenshot, VST3 and CLAP are installed, AAX and AudioUnit are not installed, VST3 is installed but older than the version contained in the installer, and the AudioUnit is selected for installation. Clicking a button a second time removes the yellow outline, and the corresponding format will not be installed. Clicking the SELECT ALL button selects all available formats for installation.

No changes to your system's storage device take place until you click the INSTALL button near the lower-right corner of the window. Click that button and you'll receive visual confirmation that the format(s) you've selected have been installed. (Yes, it happens quickly. Our products are not encumbered by any DRM or anti-piracy baggage and hence install more quickly than many others.) On Windows and Linux, if you hold down the Shift key on your keyboard, the INSTALL button's label switches to UNINSTALL, and clicking it will remove the selected formats from your system¹. Once you're installed and/or removed the formats you need, simply close the application in the usual manner for your operating system. You're done. There is no license code or other authorization necessary; we'd rather assume we can trust you than burden you with an onerous DRM system.

You'll find some handy buttons under the EXTRAS heading, all of which are pretty self-explanatory:

- EULA: presents the End-User License Agreement for our products. By clicking the INSTALL button you're implicitly agreeing to these terms, but we expect that you'll find them reasonable should you take the time to read them.
- MANUAL: opens the current version of this user manual, in PDF form, in your web browser.
- WEBSITE: opens the product's web page in your browser.
- SUPPORT: displays information for contacting us, either via our Discord presence or through email.
- SETTINGS: produces a panel in which you can choose the installation locations for each plugin format. Note that these locations are nominally stipulated by the publishers of the formats and changing them might cause problems for some hosts.
- CHANGES: displays a summary of what we've added, changed or improved since the last version of the product.

¹ Blame Apple, not us, for the lack of this feature on macOS. On macOS just manually delete the plugin(s) from your plugin folder(s).

Filters: The Basics

If you're reading this manual you probably already have some understanding of what filters do and why you need them. We're going to cover the basics here anyway, just to make sure that we have a common vocabulary. We won't be offended if you skip this section altogether.

Most filters, at their core, have just two simple controls: frequency and resonance. The frequency control usually sets the frequency at which the filter starts to change the tone or timbre of the signal. If you hear a filter effect that you might describe as making the sound "move up and down," you're probably hearing the filter's frequency control increasing and decreasing. The exact effect of the frequency control depends on the filter type, which we'll get to shortly.

The resonance control usually makes the filter's overall effect more dramatic, sharper, and/or more electronic sounding. A high resonance setting usually makes the filter boost the level of frequencies near the filter's frequency value, creating distinct overtones and sometimes a whistling-like sound. Some filters will oscillate, generating an output with no input signal, at their highest resonance settings.

Filters come in several different types which differ in how they respond to different audio frequencies. The *low-pass* filter is the filter type most commonly found in analog synthesizers. A low-pass filter attenuates or reduces signal frequencies greater than its cutoff frequency and passes signal frequencies below its cutoff frequency without alteration.

A *high-pass* filter works in a manner opposite to that of a low-pass filter: it reduces signal frequencies less than its cutoff frequency and passes signal frequencies above its cutoff frequency without alteration.

A *band-pass* filter allows a range of frequencies centered on the cutoff frequency to pass and attenuates higher and lower frequencies. The width of the band of frequencies is controlled by the Resonance control. A higher resonance setting narrows the width of the band, letting through a narrower range of frequencies.

A *notch* filter, sometimes called a *band-reject* filter, is the opposite of a band-pass filter. It attenuates a range of frequencies centered on the cutoff frequency, and allows higher and lower frequencies to pass unaltered. In other words, the filter cuts a notch in the frequencies of the signals that pass through it. The width of the notch is controlled by the resonance control; a higher resonance value makes the notch narrower, cutting fewer of the frequencies. This means that, unlike the other filter types, increasing the resonance setting of a notch filter usually creates a less-dramatic filtering effect.

Filters are also often characterized by their number of *poles*². The more poles a filter has, the more it attenuates frequencies. For instance, a 4-pole low-pass filter will attenuate frequencies above its corner frequency more than a 2-pole low-pass filter with the same frequency setting. While Moog synthesizers are justifiably famous for their 4-pole low-pass filters, filters with fewer poles also have their uses. Most early Korg and Oberheim analog synthesizers, for instance, employed 2-pole filters.

Filterstation contains all the aforementioned filter types, most with variants with different numbers of poles. There are also a few that have the same basic type and number of poles, but individual sonic characteristics, i.e. different variations on a theme.

Operation

If you're at all familiar with synthesizers, either the hardware or software variety, you'll find Filterstation familiar. Briefly, Filterstation is a pair of filters controlled by an LFO and an envelope follower. This simple description belies its flexibility, which lies in its three different routing modes, twelve different filter types, several forms of distortion processing, and independent modulation paths.

In the following pages we'll describe each of Filterstation's controls. Filterstation is not a terribly complex plug-in, but some of its controls are interrelated and explaining one necessarily involves referring to others. Hence you will find that sometimes we refer to a control in passing before later describing it in detail.

Top Bar

There are a few utility controls at the top of Filterstation's window. From left to right:

Clicking the word FILTERSTATION2 at the top left opens a pane with credits and copyright information, the current version of the plugin, and buttons for reaching our website, our Discord server, and generating an email for making a support query.

The rounded rectangle at the top center displays the name of the current preset and some associated controls. Clicking the name invokes the preset browser. We'll have more to say about presets in the appropriately named section later on in this manual.

Above the word VISUAL are three buttons for selecting what's displayed behind the filter graphs and controls that fill most of Filterstation's windows. The choices are:

- WAVE - displays a scrolling waveform of the filtered audio, that is, a depiction of its amplitude versus time.
- SPEC - displays a spectrum graph of the filtered audio, that is, a depiction of its amplitude versus frequency.
- OFF - turns off the background display.

The BYPASS button bypasses all processing with a smooth crossfade. The bypass state is saved with the preset. When Bypass is engaged, the button illuminates.

Filters One and Two

Filterstation's two filters are represented graphically in the upper half of the plug-in's window. The window shows the frequency responses of the two filters, with frequency running horizontally (lower frequencies on the left) and amplitude running vertically. The orange regions represent the filters. A scrolling waveform display of Filterstation's output signal appears in the background of this area.

Each filter has a blue oval which responds to mouse clicks and dragging. To change a filter's frequency, drag the oval horizontally. To change the filter's resonance, drag it vertically. In the following screenshot, Filter 1 is a low-pass filter with a frequency setting of about 150 Hz and a medium-high resonance, and Filter 2 is a high-pass filter with a frequency of about 1.5 kHz and a low resonance setting. Note that these representations are abstracted renditions; while they show the filter's type and frequency, they do not reflect the exact frequency response of Filterstation's different filters or their idiosyncrasies.

²Why the term "poles"? It has to do with the mathematics used to design filters, and it's something of a long story. See for example http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pole-zero_plot if you're curious.

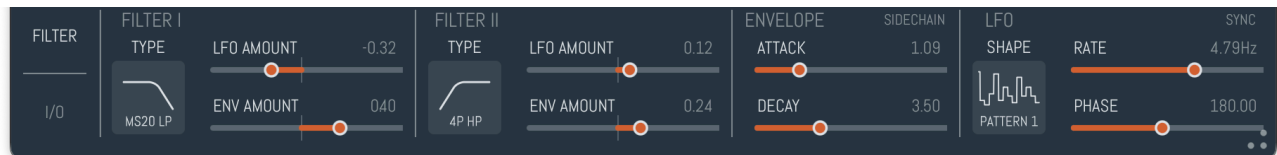


The blue circle with the linked-chain symbol lets you control both filters simultaneously. Dragging it back and forth changes the frequencies of both filters, while dragging it up and down changes their resonance settings.

As with all of Filterstation's parameters, the positions of these controls generate, and will respond to, host automation information. Hence you can record your dragging actions with your host, and/or control the filters with a hardware controller.

Filter Controls

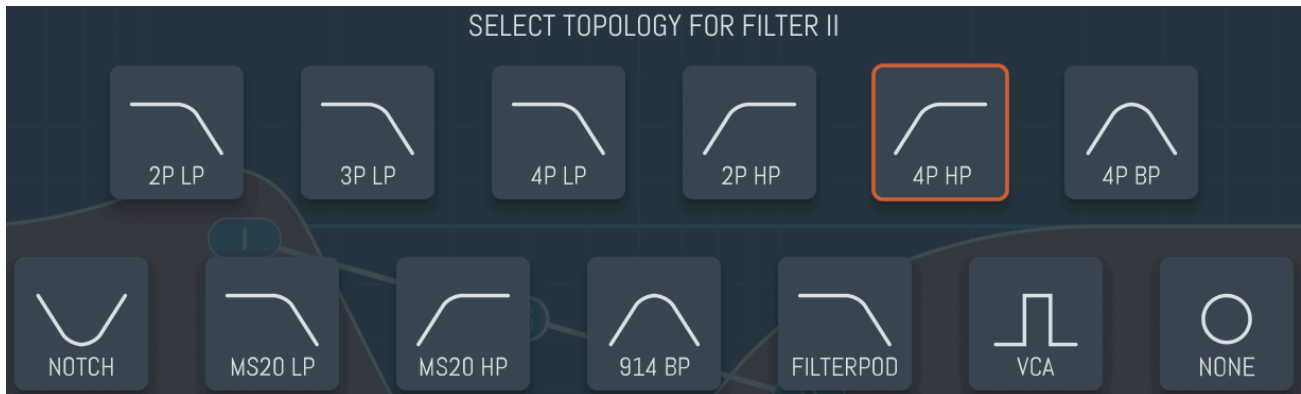
The lower section of Filterstation's window contains two sets of controls. The first set includes controls for selecting the types of the two filters, and for the LFO and envelope follower which modulate them. It looks like this:



The second set contains controls for how signals are routed through the filters, input and output level controls, and additional signal-processing functions; those are described later under I/O Controls.

Filter Types

The two filters can be independently set to one of a dozen different types. To change the filter type, click the icon labeled TYPE and then click one of the icons which appears in the pop-up selector, shown below:



The icon labels use the conventions of "P" for Poles and "LP," "HP," and "BP" for Low-Pass, High-Pass, and Band-Pass. For example, the icon labeled 4P BP selects a four-pole band-pass filter. The filter types are:

- 2P LP, 2P HP - plain-vanilla two-pole filters. If you're looking for somewhat milder-sounding filters, these are your best bet.
- 3P LP - this filter started life as an emulation of the filter in the TB-303, and has some of its squelchy sound³.
- 4P LP - Audio Damage's own 4-pole low-pass filter. Loosely based on the famous Moog filter, this is the one to use for overtly electronic-sounding filter effects.
- 4P HP - a high-pass filter with a steeper cutoff slope than its 2-pole counterpart. If you want to kill the bass in your sound, this will do the job.
- NOTCH - that's pretty much what it is. Notch filters can create phase-shifter-like effects, particularly if you use a couple of them with different frequency settings.
- MS20 LP, MS20 HP - emulations of the low-pass and high-pass filters found in the Korg MS-20 analog synthesizer. These filters have more personality than the 2P LP and 2P HP modes.
- 914 BP - the bandpass filter from Audio Damage's 914 filter bank plug-in. An accurate recreation of the filters in Moog filter bank modules, this is a bandpass filter with distinctive phase response characteristics.
- 4P BP - a band-pass filter with less resonance and coloration than the 914 BP.

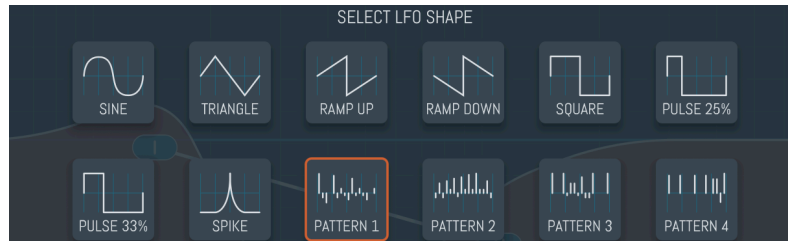
³It's a common misconception in synthesizer folklore that the TB-303 has a three-pole filter. This is incorrect; it has a four-pole filter, albeit a somewhat strange one. Back when we wrote the first version of Filterstation, we were young and impressionable and accepted this erroneous gospel without question. We're older and possibly wiser now, but we still like the way this three-pole filter sounds, so it is preserved without alteration in this version.

- **FILTERPOD** - the filter from one of Audio Damage's first products, Filterpod. It's essentially a low-pass filter with an odd hump near its cutoff frequency, and some unusual resonance and overdrive characteristics.
- **VCA** - not really a filter as such. Like the module commonly found in synthesizers, the VCA mode changes the loudness of signals, rather than changing their timbre. Changing the filter's frequency parameter changes the level of the signal. This means that Filterstation is quite capable of creating a variety of volume-based effects, such as tremolo, gating, and auto-panning.
- **NONE** - if you choose this mode, the filter is removed from the signal path altogether. This setting is useful if you need to focus on the sound of the other filter while adjusting it, or if you simply find that just one of Filterstation's filters is enough to do the job.

Low-Frequency Oscillator (LFO)

Filterstation has a single low-frequency oscillator (LFO) for controlling the filters. The LFO can modulate the frequency of either or both filters.

SHAPES - The LFO has a selection of different wave shapes. Click the icon labeled **SHAPE** to invoke the shape selector, then click one of the shape icons as shown here:



The following shapes are available:

- **SINE** - a sinusoidal wave which rises and falls smoothly, with no corners or sudden jumps.
- **TRIANGLE** - a wave which moves up and down in straight lines, rising at the same speed that it falls.
- **RAMP UP** - a wave which rises slowly from zero to its maximum value, then jumps back to zero.
- **RAMP DOWN** - the opposite of RAMP UP: it jumps from zero to its maximum value, then falls slowly to zero.
- **SQUARE** - a wave which jumps between zero and its maximum value, staying at both values for the same amount of time.
- **33% PULSE** - like the SQUARE wave, but it stays at the maximum value for 1/3 of its total time and at zero for 2/3 of the time.
- **25% PULSE** - like the SQUARE wave, but it stays at the maximum value for 1/4 of its total time and at zero for 3/4 of the time.
- **SPIKE** - this wave rises quickly from zero to the maximum value, and then falls back to zero.
- **PATTERN 1–4** - these settings produce 16-step rhythmic patterns for creating burbling filter sequences, trance-gate patterns, etc.

LFO AMOUNT - Each filter has its own LFO AMOUNT control, which sets how much the LFO changes the filter's frequency. These controls have a range of -1.00 to $+1.00$. Larger values, either positive or negative, have a greater effect on the filter. If you set the LFO AMOUNT control to a positive value, the LFO will increase the filter's frequency. (For low-pass filters, this is usually called "opening" the filter, since it allows more harmonic content to pass through.) If you set the LFO AMOUNT to a negative value, the LFO will decrease the filter's frequency. Although Filterstation has one LFO which is shared by the two filters, you can set their LFO amounts to opposite polarities and cause the filters to move in different directions.

RATE and SYNC - The RATE control determines how fast Filterstation's LFO changes the filter frequencies. It operates either in time units—the number of cycles per second—or in metrical units, depending on the setting of the SYNC switch. If the SYNC switch is off, the LFO runs at whatever rate you set with the RATE control, which can be as slow as 0.01 Hz (one cycle every 100 seconds) and as fast as 100 Hz. If the SYNC switch is on, the LFO synchronizes to the tempo and position of your host DAW's transport, and the RATE control operates in metrical units, expressed as fractions of a measure. For instance, if the RATE control is set to $1/4$, the LFO will complete four cycles every measure. In this mode the RATE control has a range of $1/32$ to $2/1$ (one cycle every two measures). Dotted and triplet values are indicated with a . (dot) and T respectively. Turn sync on and off by simply clicking the word SYNC.

PHASE - The PHASE control sets the starting position of the LFO's waveform—its phase—when it begins a cycle at the beginning of a measure. Phase is expressed in degrees and ranges from 0 to 360. The exact effect of the PHASE control varies depending on which LFO shape you're using. If SYNC is off, the PHASE control has no audible effect.

Envelope Follower

Filterstation can respond to the loudness of the incoming signal with its envelope follower. The envelope follower generates a modulation signal that rises and falls in proportion to the loudness of the input signal, and can be used—like the LFO—to control the frequencies of either of the filters, or both.

ATTACK and DECAY - The envelope follower has two parameters for adjusting how it responds to the signal: ATTACK and DECAY. ATTACK controls how quickly the envelope follower's output increases when the level of the input signal increases. DECAY does the opposite, controlling how fast the output decreases when the input signal's level falls. If you're using the envelope follower with a signal like drums or electric bass, you'll probably want to use an attack value near zero so that the envelope follower responds rapidly. Adjust the decay setting to smooth out or extend the response of the envelope follower as the notes die away. With sustained sounds like synthesizer pads, you can use a longer attack time to create fade-in effects that open the filters slowly as you hold chords. In conjunction with the VCA filter mode, a longer attack time can create slow-gear effects for guitar.

ENVELOPE AMOUNT - Each filter has its own ENVELOPE AMOUNT control, which sets how much the envelope follower changes the filter's frequency. These controls have a range of -1.00 to $+1.00$. Larger values, either positive or negative, have a greater effect on the filter. If you set the ENVELOPE AMOUNT control to a positive value, the envelope follower will increase the filter's frequency when the input signal gets louder. If you set the ENVELOPE AMOUNT to a negative value, the envelope follower will decrease the filter's frequency.

SIDE-CHAIN INPUT - Filterstation has a pair of auxiliary inputs which will appear in your host as "SC." If the switch labeled **SIDECHAIN** is turned on, the signal from these inputs is fed to the envelope follower. This lets you use a different instrument to control the filters, similar to how a side-chain compressor lets you control the loudness of one instrument with another. For instance, you could use a kick drum to apply rhythmic filtering to a synthesizer, or use your voice to control the filter. In general, these are the steps for setting up side-chain control of Filterstation:

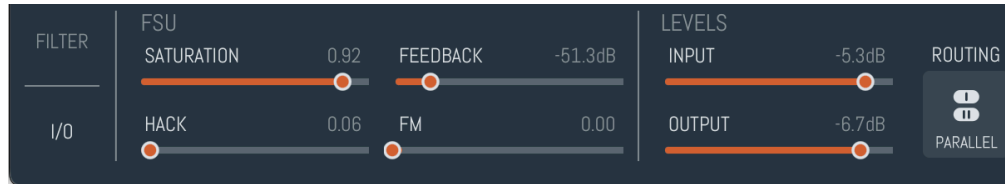
- 1) Insert Filterstation on the track with the instrument that will be filtered (e.g., the synthesizer in the first example mentioned above).

- 2) Route a signal from the track with the instrument that will control the filter (e.g., the kick drum in the first example) to Filterstation's side-chain inputs. Usually you'll want to use a "send" control on that track, but you can also route the output of the track to Filterstation if you don't want to hear the controlling instrument in your mix.
- 3) Turn on the side-chain input in Filterstation by clicking the SIDECHAIN button.
- 4) For starters, set the ATTACK and DECAY sliders to zero.
- 5) Move the ENVELOPE AMOUNT slider(s) to the right or left to adjust how much the side-chain signal controls the filter(s).
- 6) Adjust the ATTACK and DECAY sliders to smooth out or lengthen the envelope follower's response.

Support for side-chain inputs varies depending on both the plug-in type and your host's signal-routing features.

I/O Controls

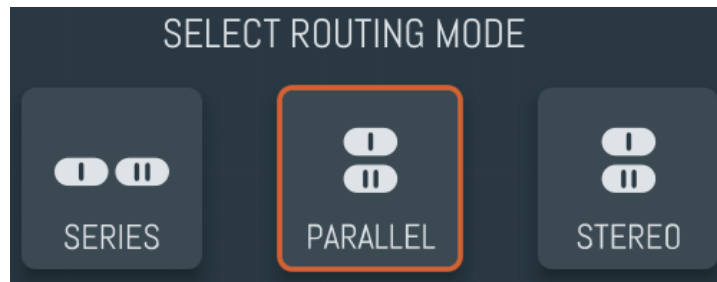
Click the label I/O at the bottom left of Filterstation's window to reveal another set of controls.



Routing Modes

Filterstation has three different ways of routing audio through its two filters. These are chosen with the switches near the top of Filterstation's window. The three choices are:

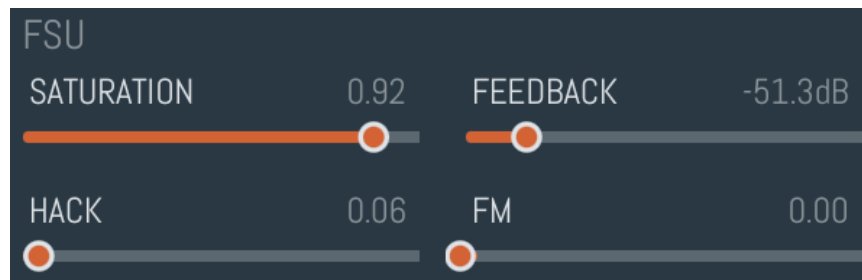
- Series - the signal passes through Filter 1 first and then through Filter 2.
- Parallel - the signal is split and passes through Filter 1 and Filter 2 simultaneously, and the outputs of the two filters are added together.
- Stereo - the left audio signal passes through Filter 1, and the right audio signal passes through Filter 2.



Click on the icon labeled ROUTING, then click one of the icons in the selector to choose the corresponding routing configuration. Filterstation uses separate filters for the left and right channels, so a stereo signal path is present regardless of the routing configuration.

Note that it's not difficult to create configurations in which no sound at all comes out of Filterstation. Suppose, for example, you use the Series routing and band-pass types for both Filter 1 and Filter 2. If the frequency settings of the two filters are far enough apart, nothing will come out of Filter 2: only a narrow range of frequencies will be emitted by Filter 1, and Filter 2 will block them. However, if you were to switch to the Parallel routing, you'd hear an interesting double-peak effect, since the raw input signal would enter both filters and their outputs would be mixed.

FSU



This section contains controls which distort the signal in various ways. The effect of these controls is highly dependent on the signals entering Filterstation, the currently active filter types, and the settings of other controls. Hence the result of manipulating these controls is somewhat unpredictable. If you're using Filterstation because you need clean, subtle filtering effects, you probably won't find much use for these controls. On the other hand, if you're looking to mangle sounds, these controls are your new friends. The letters "FSU" might stand for Foul Stuff Up, or Forced Signal Unpleasantness, or, well, use your imagination.

SATURATION - The Saturation slider applies a variable amount of analog-like distortion to the signal before it enters the filter. The slider has no effect at its leftmost position. As you move it to the right, the signal becomes increasingly distorted.

FEEDBACK - The Feedback slider routes some of Filterstation's output signal back into its input. The further right you move the slider, the more signal is fed back. This may cause the entire plug-in to oscillate loudly, so exercise caution.

HACK - The Hack control damages audio with noise whose character is dependent on both the input signal's loudness and the frequency setting of Filter 1. At settings near the left end of the scale, you'll hear Hack only on the louder peaks of the input signal. Moving the Hack slider to the right increases the amount of damage.

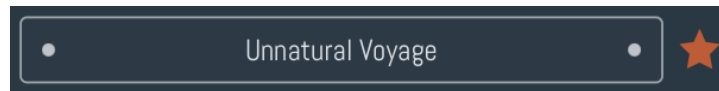
FM - FM stands for Frequency Modulation. The FM slider changes (modulates) the filter frequencies with the input audio signal itself. This is different than using the envelope follower for modulation: while the envelope follower responds to the amplitude or loudness of the signal, the FM control responds instantaneously to the shape, and thus the frequency, of the signal. Moving the slider to the right increases the amount of FM. Small amounts of FM can create a subtle fluttering or produce sounds like tremolo effects. More FM can make sounds fizzy or flatulent.

Levels

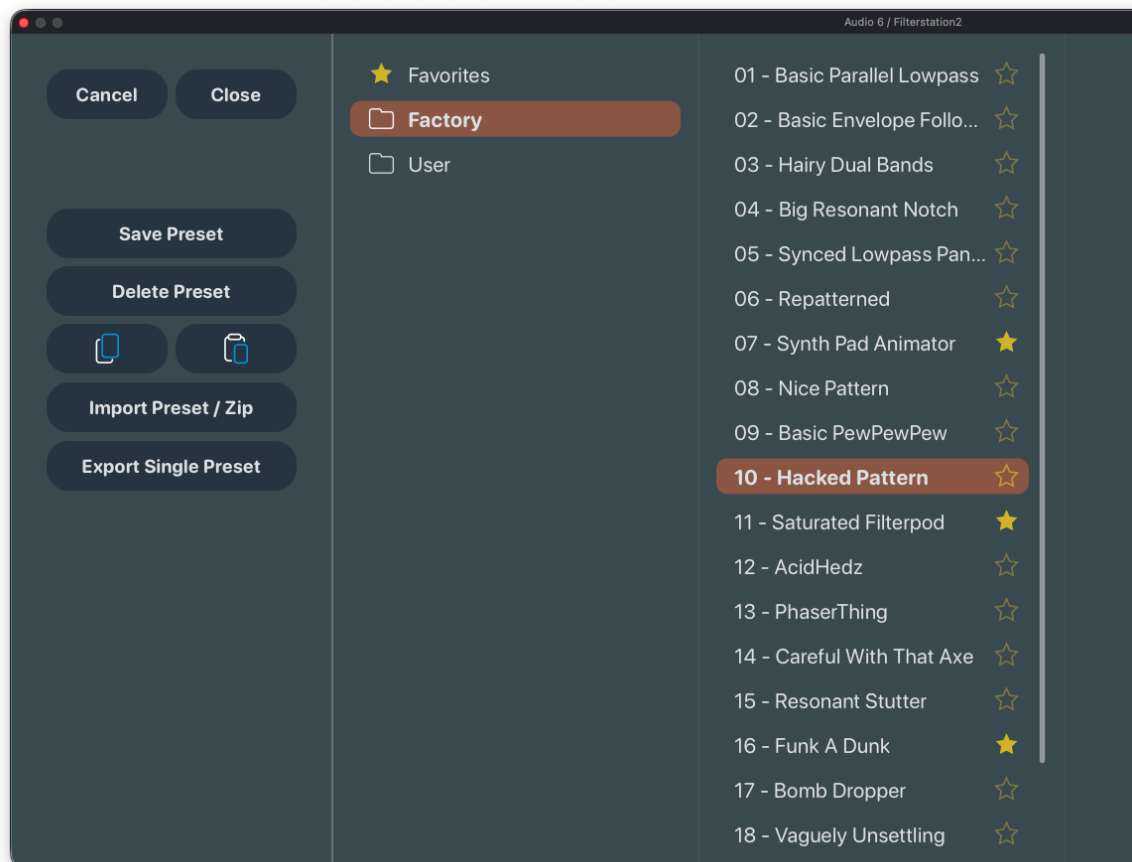
Finally, Filterstation has a pair of sliders for controlling the level or amplitude of the signals entering and leaving the plug-in. In most cases you can probably leave these sliders at their rightmost position, which provides unity gain. If you find that the output of Filterstation is a bit loud, use the OUTPUT slider to reduce it. On the other hand, use the INPUT slider to lower the level of the signal entering the plug-in. Since the filters and FSU controls respond differently depending on the level of the signal passing through them, you might find that automating the INPUT slider produces interesting effects.

Presets

Filterstation includes a collection of presets to serve as a demonstration of its capabilities and inspirations for your own creations. There are a few controls at the top of the window associated with presets:



The name of the current preset appears in the center. (You probably figured that out yourself.) Clicking the little dots on the left and right loads presets in alphabetical order. Clicking the star outline marks the preset as a favorite to help you find it again in the future. To examine all of the presets, click the name of the current to open the preset browser.



The browser displays presets and folders in scrollable lists, arranged in columns. The leftmost list shows the folders within Filterstation's preset collection, grouped in two categories: Factory and User. Clicking any of these folders reveals its contents in the next list. Clicking on a preset name loads the settings into Filterstation. Click the CLOSE button in the preset browser to dismiss it. If you click the CANCEL button instead, the browser closes and Filterstation's settings revert to their previous state. Double-clicking a preset name loads the preset and dismisses the preset browser. Loading a preset irretrievably erases the current settings, so if you have created something that you want to use again, save it as a new preset before loading another preset.

Once you have clicked on any item in the panel, you can navigate within the preset browser with the keys on your keyboard. The left and right arrow keys move the selection between columns, and the up and down arrow keys move it within the list. Tapping the ESC key has the same effect as clicking the Cancel button.

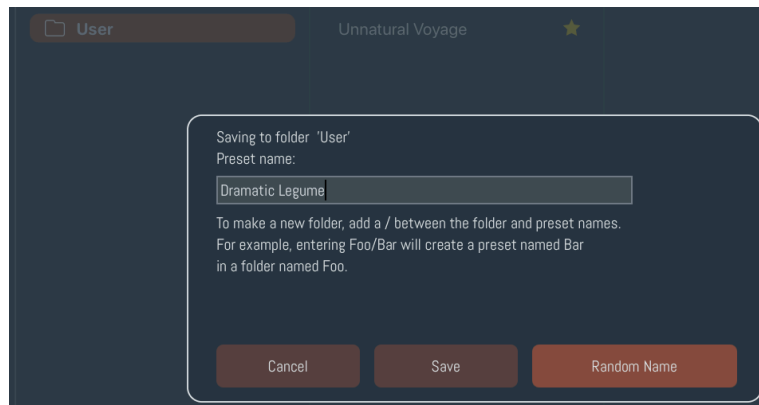
Just like the star at the top of the window which we mentioned previously, the stars to the right of preset names mark presets as favorites. Clicking a filled start removes the mark from a favorite. Once you've marked at least one favorite, a correspondingly named category appears in the leftmost column. Clicking it shows you all the presets you've marked, and clicking their names loads them as usual.

The folders and presets in the browser correspond to folders and files within Filterstation's own folder on your storage device (i.e. your computer's hard drive or SSD). This folder is located at `C:\ProgramData\Audio Damage\Filterstation2\` on Windows, and `~/Music/Audio Damage/Filterstation2/` on macOS and Linux. You can

store your presets anywhere you like, but for them to show up in the User list they must be placed in the User folder within Filterstation's folder. Also, to avoid possible collisions during future updates, do not store your presets within the Factory folder.

Any folders you create within the User folder will show up as folders in the User list. You can create sub-folders within the User folder, and sub-folders within those folders. You can't nest folders deeper than that because the preset browser has only four lists.

To save your presets, click the SAVE PRESET button at the left edge of the window. This invokes a dialog box with a couple of helpful features. As the text therein describes, you can create a folder within the destination folder (whose name is given at the top of the dialog box) by adding the folder's name to the beginning of the preset's name, separated by a slash mark.



Clicking the RANDOM NAME button replaces the preset's name with a pair of words chosen at random from two lists. While the resulting names won't have any connection with what the plugin is doing, you may find this feature useful for coming up with alternatives to routine names like "My Preset 12".

Potential pitfall: once you've saved a preset, clicking its name in the list loads the preset, overwriting whatever changes you've made since you saved the preset. Hence if you want to save the preset again to preserve the changes you've made, do not click on its name before saving it.

You can delete presets and folders from the lists by clicking their name and then clicking the DELETE PRESET or DELETE FOLDER button. Filterstation will give you a chance to confirm this action or cancel it. If you confirm, the preset/folder will be removed from your storage system and is gone for good.

Importing and Exporting Presets

Preset files are plain-text XML files so that you can exchange them online in forums, copy them between a Windows computer and a Macintosh (and even between an iPad and a regular computer), email them to your friends, etc.

The two buttons with icons representing copying and pasting (copy on the left, paste on the right) copy Filterstation's current settings to the system clipboard and paste settings from the clipboard. You can use the copy and paste commands to transfer settings between two instances of Filterstation or paste the settings into an email message or text editor. When copied to the clipboard, presets are presented in the same XML text as used in preset files.

The IMPORT PRESET/ZIP button provides a way to add presets to Filterstation without manually moving them into the appropriate folders in your file system. Clicking this button produces a file-browser window wherein you can select either a single preset file or a .zip file containing one or more presets. After you select the file, Filterstation copies the preset(s) into whichever folder you have selected in Filterstation's preset list, unzipping the file first if necessary.

Depending on whether you've selected a preset or folder, the EXPORT SINGLE PRESET or EXPORT FOLDER AS ZIP button performs the complementary functions of the Import button. First select either a preset or a folder in Filterstation's list, then click the export button. A file-save window appears; choose a location in your file system, give the file a name, and click SAVE. If you have chosen a folder in Filterstation's preset list, the plugin places it and all of the presets it contains in a .zip file.

Default Preset

If you save a preset with the special name "Default" in the User folder, new instances of Filterstation will load it automatically when you add it to your DAW session. You can use a default preset file to give yourself the same starting point with Filterstation whenever you use it. The plugin installer creates a default preset file for you but feel free to replace it with your own.

And Finally...

Thanks for purchasing Filterstation. We make every effort to ensure your satisfaction with our products and want you to be happy with your purchase. Please write to support@audiodamage.com if you have any questions or comments.

Document Revisions

- 2026-06-17:
 - Updated for version 2.3.0 release.
 - Screenshots updated.
 - Formatting updated while converting to QMD.